

Fourth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Quarta Post Pentecosten

TLM props: light, travail, Christ's word, and the merciful compelling of rebellious wills

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Dominus illuminatio mea; si consistant adversum me castra, non timebit cor meum</i> (Ps. 26:1–3)	Light, salvation, protection, courage	The Lord is named as light, salvation, and protector; enemies fall, and even an encamped host need not make the heart fear.
Collect	<i>mundi cursus pacifice nobis tuo ordine dirigatur; Ecclesia tua tranquilla devotione laetetur</i>	Ordered course and tranquil devotion	The Church asks God peacefully to direct the world's course and let the Church rejoice in tranquil devotion.
Epistle	Rom. 8:18–23	Suffering, creation, firstfruits, body	Creation and believers groan in hope: present suffering opens toward glory, freedom from corruption, and redemption of the body.
Gradual	<i>Propitius esto, Domine, peccatis nostris; Adiuva nos</i> (Ps. 78:9–10)	Pardon, help, deliverance, God's name	The endangered people ask forgiveness and rescue for the honor of God's name, lest the nations ask where their God is.
Alleluia	<i>Deus, qui sedes super thronum, et iudicas aequitatem; refugium pauperum</i> (Ps. 9:5, 10)	Equitable judgment and refuge	The enthroned equitable Judge is acclaimed as the poor person's refuge in tribulation.
Gospel	Luke 5:1–11	Teaching, command, catch, confession, call	Christ teaches, commands a cast after an empty night, gives abundance, answers Peter's confession and fear, and calls him to catch people.
Offertory	<i>Illumina oculos meos, ne unquam obdormiam in morte</i> (Ps. 12:4–5)	Interior light against death	The offerer asks God to illuminate the eyes, lest sleep in death let the enemy claim victory.
Secret	<i>Oblationibus nostris ... susceptis; ad te nostras etiam rebelles compelle propitius voluntates</i>	Accepted gifts and resistant wills	God is asked to receive the oblations and mercifully compel even rebellious wills toward himself.
Communion	<i>Dominus firmamentum meum, et refugium meum, et liberator meus</i> (Ps. 17:3)	Strength, refuge, deliverance, help	The communicant names the Lord, rather than the self, as strength, refuge, deliverer, and helper.
Postcommunion	<i>Mysteria ... sumpta purificent: et suo munere tueantur</i>	Purification and protection	The mysteries already received are asked both to purify their recipients and to protect them by their gift.
Sense	Synthesis		
Literal	Romans describes creation and believers groaning for bodily redemption; Luke narrates Christ teaching from Simon's boat, commanding another cast, granting an overwhelming catch, and calling Peter after his confession.		
Allegorical	Cyril and Ambrose read the catch as apostolic gathering under Christ's word; Augustine distinguishes Luke's burdened present catch from the unbroken net at the risen Christ's shore in John 21.		
Moral	The disciple tells the truth about failure, obeys Christ's word before seeing a result, confesses sin amid abundance, and asks for illuminated sight and the merciful compelling of a rebellious will toward God.		
Anagogical	Creation's travail tends toward freedom from corruption, the body toward glory, and the present mixed catch toward the final communion Augustine sees figured by John 21.		

Condensed Authoritative Exposition

Governing thesis: divine action restores creaturely action

The propers neither leave creation, Church, or will to save themselves nor reduce them to inert instruments. God illumines, orders, forgives, commands, receives, mercifully compels, purifies, and protects; creatures groan, hope, pray, obey, confess, follow, offer, and take refuge. Christ's word brings exhausted labor into apostolic service, while Romans keeps that service inside the larger hope of bodily and cosmic liberation.

1. **Light & order** → 2. **Groan, ask & obey** → 3. **Sight & conversion** → 4. **Refuge & effect**
Introit–Collect *Epistle–Gospel* *Offertory–Secret* *Communion–Postcommunion*

1. Illumined life moves under received order (*Int., Coll., Ep.*)

Appointed claim	Decisive witness	Visible boundary
Light amid conflict	Augustine, <i>Psalm 26</i> , 1–3, joins divine illumination and salvation to courage under assault.	Confidence rests in God; the psalm does not call danger imaginary.
A course directed	The Collect's subject is <i>mundi cursus</i> , a world in motion; God's order is the requested source of peace. Augustine, <i>City of God</i> XIX.13, calls the peace of all things the tranquility of order.	His definition illuminates the prayer but is not direct commentary on it; peace is not simply comfort or political quiet.
Travail under hope	Chrysostom, <i>Romans</i> 14, reads creation's groaning as travail tending toward newness and the body's irreversible freedom from corruption.	Travail is not yet birth; firstfruits are not final possession.

2. Mercy, judgment, and command meet truthful need (*Grad., All., Gosp.*)

Movement	Text and inherited witness	Control
Need speaks	The Gradual asks help, deliverance, and mercy toward sins for God's name. Augustine, <i>Psalm 78</i> , 12–13, calls God the healer: help neither denies grace nor removes the action of the one helped.	The prayer seeks God's honor, not the worshipper's vindication.
Judgment shelters	The Alleluia names God as equitable Judge and refuge for the poor. Augustine, <i>Psalm 9</i> , 6 and 10, distinguishes God's knowledge of hearts from human judgment and locates refuge in him.	Refuge does not cancel judgment; judgment does not make refuge unsafe.
The word gives and calls	Teaching precedes command; truthful failure and obedience precede the catch; confession, "fear not," vocation, and following come after. Cyril keeps the result Christ's; Ambrose joins doctrine, humility, and office.	No promise makes every faithful undertaking measurably successful; abundance certifies Christ's power, not Peter's perfection.

3. Illumined eyes and rebellious wills are brought to God (*Off.*, *Sec.*)

Textual hinge	What is established	Source and boundary
<i>Illumina oculos meos</i>	Sight is requested as a gift against death and the enemy.	Augustine, <i>Psalm 12</i> , 3–6, reads the heart’s eyes, sin’s eclipse, and steadfastness as mercy; illumination is not mere information.
<i>Oblationibus ... susceptis</i>	An ablative absolute: the oblations have been received; acceptance remains God’s act.	The offerers act truly, but this clause does not identify their wills as the oblations.
<i>ad te ... voluntates</i>	The wills are the object of <i>compelle</i> , and God himself is their personal end.	Conversion is more than improved performance; the syntax does not identify these wills with the oblations.
<i>etiam rebelles compelle propitius</i>	Resistance is real, efficacious action is requested, and <i>propitius</i> governs its merciful mode.	Augustine, <i>Grace and Free Will</i> 31–33, and Chrysostom on Phil. 2:12–13 preserve gifted and real willing; the prayer warrants no human coercion.

4. The receiver rests in another’s strength and still needs effect (*Comm.*, *Postcomm.*)

Proper	Dependence named	Decisive control
Communion	The Lord is strength, refuge, deliverer, God, and helper.	Augustine, <i>Psalm 17</i> , 2–3, speaks in the voice of whole Christ: strength and hope begin in God’s prior help, not proud reliance on self.
Postcommunion	Reception is complete (<i>sumpta</i>), yet purification and protection remain petitions.	The sacramental gift is not treated as a trophy of visible success or an excuse to stop asking for grace.

Four guardrails — recoverable at a glance

- **Hope tells the truth about pain.** Travail has a promised end; suffering is neither denied nor made saving by itself.
- **Salvation remains embodied.** Romans awaits redemption of *our body*; Irenaeus identifies the mortal body as the body God vivifies.
- **Gift does not certify the recipient.** The catch brings Peter to confession and discipleship, not self-congratulation.
- **Grace does not abolish agency.** God commands, compels mercifully, purifies, and protects; the person obeys, follows, offers, and asks.

Agency throughout — distinct subjects, one graced action

God illumines, orders, forgives, commands, gives, receives, compels mercifully, purifies, and protects. **The worshipper** hopes, reports failure, obeys, confesses, follows, offers, and petitions. **The Church** bears present strain, shares apostolic labor, receives the mysteries, and still asks for their continuing effect.

Expansive Authoritative Exposition

Four opening voices establish the Sunday's field (*Int.*, *Coll.*, *Grad.*, *All.*)

The appointed wording supplies four discrete claims: God is light and protector; world and Church ask ordered peace; sinners ask pardon and help for God's name; the equitable Judge is refuge. Inherited reception clarifies each without imposing a lake metaphor.

Proper	Direct inherited reception	Contribution	Qualification
Introit and Collect	Augustine, <i>Psalm 26</i> , 1–3, reads divine light and protection amid assault. The Collect asks that a moving <i>cursus</i> be directed by God's <i>ordo</i> .	Courage rests in God; Augustine, <i>City of God</i> XIX.13, illuminates ordered peace and tranquil devotion.	The psalm exposition is direct; the treatise is related illumination, and no secure direct commentary on the prayer was located.
Gradual	Augustine, <i>Psalm 78</i> , 12–13, reads “help us” through God as healer, grace that aids action, forgiveness, and glory in God's name.	Sin and weakness are confessed while real action remains possible under help.	“Where is their God?” is, for Augustine, concern for nations tempted to despair of the true God.
Alleluia	Augustine, <i>Psalm 9</i> , 6 and 9–10, distinguishes divine judgment of hearts from human judgment and calls God the poor person's refuge in tribulation.	Equity and asylum are not rival divine roles.	The verse does not spatially identify the throne with Christ's seat in the boat.

Romans 8: travail tends toward bodily glory (*Ep.*)

Romans 8:18–23 is not a general maxim that pain eventually pays. Paul compares present sufferings with glory to be revealed, then gives creation a voice: it was subjected to vanity in hope, groans in travail, and awaits the revelation of God's children. Believers possess the firstfruits of the Spirit while still groaning for adoption's completion, “the redemption of our body.” Possession and waiting, gift and ache, remain simultaneous.

Pauline hinge	Chrysostom's direct exegesis	Doctrinal force	Limit
Expectation under hope	Paul personifies creation, subjected to corruption in connection with fallen humanity yet promised liberation.	Non-rational creation is good and belongs to humanity's history and future honor.	Personification does not assign human psychology to every creature; creation and humanity remain distinct.
Groaning and travail	Chrysostom hears labor pains ordered toward newness, not pain circling without an end.	Christian lament can be unguardedly truthful because hope rests in God's promised act.	Birth imagery does not make suffering good in itself.
Firstfruits and bodily redemption	The Spirit is a genuine pledge while believers await the body's complete, irreversible freedom from corruption.	Already and not-yet stay joined; salvation is not escape from embodiment.	Firstfruits rule out despair, waiting rules out presumption, and resurrection exceeds return to present mortality.

St. Irenaeus — related Pauline illumination
<i>Against Heresies</i> V.7.1–2 appeals to Romans 8:11: the mortal body that dies is the body the Spirit vivifies. “Spiritual body” therefore names this body raised through the Spirit for enduring life, not a replacement for discarded matter. Irenaeus comments on a closely related Pauline verse, not directly on Romans 8:18–23.

Luke 5: Christ teaches, commands, gives, and calls (*Gosp.*)

Luke’s narrative order prevents the catch from becoming a free-standing success story. The crowd first presses to hear God’s word; Jesus teaches from Simon’s boat; only then does he command another cast. Simon reports expert failure without disguise and obeys before the result. The catch exceeds private capacity, Peter confesses sin, Christ answers fear, and the fishermen leave the abundance to follow its giver.

Narrative turn	St. Cyril of Alexandria	St. Ambrose	Interpretive control
Word before sign	The future fishers are first caught by Christ’s teaching; the sign pledges the teacher’s almighty power.	Christ chooses Peter’s boat as a place of teaching before directing its labor.	Mission receives doctrine and authority; results do not create them.
<i>Duc in altum</i>	Creation obeys Christ’s will, and he supplies what the net cannot produce.	In IV.71 the “deep” includes the depth of confession concerning the Son’s divine generation.	Launching deep is not merely motivational daring.
The catch	Cyril reads it as a type of apostolic preaching among the nations; Christ continues to fill the net.	Apostolic discourse brings persons from depths and obscurity into spiritual light alive.	The type does not promise numerical abundance to every faithful undertaking.
Partners and boats	Later pastors cooperate in a work whose efficacy remains Christ’s.	Ambrose permits several ecclesial readings of the two boats or peoples.	Cooperation is real; no one symbolic identification exhausts the scene.
Confession and call	Peter’s fear is reverence before Christ’s purity and power.	Empty presumption yields to humility, confession, gift, and vocation.	Grace answers guilt without pretending Peter is already complete.

Luke’s burdened catch and John’s completed shore (*Gosp.*)

Augustine reads Luke 5 beside John 21 without denying either event’s literal history. In *Tractate 122 on John*, 7, the differences form an ecclesiological contrast: Luke’s catch signifies the Church in the present age, while John’s post-Resurrection catch signifies her final condition.

Feature	Luke 5	John 21	Augustine’s reading
Setting and catch	Before the Passion; immense and unnumbered; boats remain on the water.	After the Resurrection; 153 fish are drawn to Christ on shore.	Present gathering precedes resurrection’s stability and the number completed by God.
Net	It strains and tears.	It is explicitly not torn.	Present communion suffers rupture; final communion cannot be broken.
Fish	No right-side cast or final sorting is narrated.	The cast is on the right and the fish reach shore.	The present gathering is mixed; final manifestation belongs to the end.
Boats	Two boats fill and nearly sink.	The catch reaches land without sinking the boat.	Ecclesial burden does not mean Christ’s word has failed.

The contrast guards both directions: abundance cannot certify every person or structure, and strain cannot refute Christ’s agency. Purity and completion belong to the shore still awaited.

The offered petition is for wakeful interior sight (*Off.*)

Psalm 12 moves from delay and sorrow through a plea for illuminated eyes to trust in mercy. The Offertory appoints the petition, not a boast about achieved clarity.

St. Augustine — direct exposition of Psalm 12:4–5
In sections 3–6 Augustine identifies the enemy as the devil or entrenched carnal habit. The eyes are the eyes of the heart, liable to a pleasurable eclipse through sin; sleep in death names the danger of losing faith’s light. Even steadfastness is attributed to God’s mercy, so the petition opposes both despair and self-reliance.

At Offertory the gift-bearer still asks to see, remain awake, and escape the enemy’s claim. The Introit’s indicative—the Lord is my light—and this imperative—illuminate my eyes—remain distinct forms of dependence.

The Secret asks acceptance and merciful compulsion (*Sec.*)

Only decisive clauses appear here; the complete prayer remains in the hand missal and repository record.

Latin hinge	Grammatical force	Theological pressure
<i>Oblationibus nostris ... susceptis placare ... et ad te</i>	Ablative absolute: our oblations having been received A passive imperative asks favorable disposition; <i>et</i> coordinates a second petition whose end is God.	Reception is God’s act; the gifts are truly ours without becoming leverage over him. Sacrifice is ordered toward reconciliation, while conversion is personal direction toward God.
<i>nostras etiam rebelles compelle propitius voluntates</i>	The wills are the object; resistance is named; efficacious action is requested in a favorable, merciful mode.	The prayer neither conceals resistance nor grants it the final word; divine action is not human coercion or annihilation of agency.

The syntactic boundary

The prayer coordinates two petitions: accept the oblations and be favorable; mercifully compel rebellious wills toward God. It does *not* identify the wills as the oblations. Their relation within one prayer is liturgically suggestive, but “the will as interior offering” would be theological synthesis rather than translation.

Augustine’s *Confessions* VIII.5 and 8–12 narrates a will divided through entrenched habit without dividing the person into alien substances. *Grace and Free Will* 31–33 says that God gives what he commands by helping the commanded person obey; grace initiates willing and cooperates in action. Chrysostom, on Philippians 2:12–13, likewise joins God’s working of willing and action to exhortation, effort, and obedience. These sources illuminate the doctrine at stake; none is direct commentary on this Secret.

Refuge received, purification still requested (*Comm., Postcomm.*)

Psalm 17 is David’s song of deliverance, and Augustine reads its speaking subject as whole Christ, head and body. In sections 2–3, “my strength” means the Lord by whom the speaker is strong; refuge follows divine deliverance; hope rests on the help of God’s prior call; the defender prevents proud reliance upon self. Communion therefore gives the Church a voice of received strength rather than acquired invulnerability.

The Postcommunion preserves the same dependence after reception. The mysteries are *sumpta*, taken or received, and precisely as received they are asked to purify and protect. The prayer names no visible result as proof that their work is finished.

St. Irenaeus — Eucharist and the body's future

Against Heresies V.2.2–3 argues that Eucharistic bread and cup nourish the flesh with Christ's body and blood; that same flesh is capable of God's gift and will rise incorruptibly. This related doctrinal witness closes the distance between Romans' bodily redemption and sacramental reception without pretending that Irenaeus comments on this Communion antiphon or Postcommunion.

Speculative Exposition

Exploratory mode. These AI-assisted readings begin from the appointed propers but are not attributed to the cited authorities and make no claim about historical compositional intent.

Peaceful order is motion, not stillness. (*Coll., Gosp.*) The Collect does not ask God to stop the *mundi cursus*; it asks that the course be directed peacefully in his order. The Gospel then gives a small narrative icon of directed motion: push away from shore, go into depth, lower the net, return, and finally leave the boats to follow. Peace may be less like sheltered immobility than movement whose direction has been received. Yet the Collect's cosmic and ecclesial petition should not be reduced to a lesson in personal risk-taking, and turmoil is not automatically evidence of faithful motion.

The throne and the teacher's seat. (*All., Gosp.*) The Alleluia acclaims God seated upon a throne; Luke shows Christ sitting in a borrowed fishing boat to teach a crowd on land. The juxtaposition invites a paradox of authority: equitable judgment and refuge are voiced immediately before divine teaching comes from an unstable, work-worn platform. The boat need not become a throne for the scene to disclose sovereignty without spectacle. The stronger alternative is simpler: the texts may only place two independent acts of sitting next to one another, and the Alleluia never mentions the lake.

Travail and the straining net. (*Ep., Gosp.*) Romans gives pain the form of labor awaiting birth; Luke gives abundance the form of nets tearing and boats nearly sinking. Together they challenge the idea that strain proves sterility. Some burdens belong to corruption and cry for release; another burden comes from a gift that exceeds present capacity. Discernment must ask whether a structure is dying, giving birth, or straining under fruit—and perhaps more than one at once. The images are not interchangeable: Paul promises cosmic liberation, while Luke narrates one apostolic sign.

Two illuminations and one fear answered. (*Int., Gosp., Off.*) At entrance the Lord is *illuminatio mea*; at offering the Church asks *illumina oculos meos*. Between them Peter sees abundance, sees himself as sinful, and hears *Noli timere*. The liturgical sequence can be heard as light becoming more interior and more costly: first confidence against external enemies, then exposure before holiness, then a plea that the heart not fall asleep. “Whom shall I fear?” is not bravado; its answer may arrive by passing through the fear that grace awakens and Christ redirects.

The net and the rebellious will. (*Gosp., Sec.*) The Gospel's net gathers living persons under Christ's command; the Secret asks God mercifully to compel resistant wills toward himself. Their proximity suggests a daring model of mission: grace catches without reducing the caught to objects, and divine efficacy creates followers who leave, walk, and act. The net is then not a human technology for controlling belief but an image of being drawn into liberated agency. Luke's miracle does not settle the metaphysics of *compelle*, and the prayer cannot license coercion by Church or state.

Success still needs purification. (*Gosp., Postcomm.*) The catch looks like completion, yet Luke ends with abandonment of the catch and a beginning of discipleship. The Mass likewise reaches sacramental reception and then asks that what has been received purify and protect. Grace's visible fruit may therefore be a threshold rather than a certificate: the successful worker must still be converted by the gift, guarded from possessing it, and led beyond the result into following. This does not make outcomes irrelevant; it denies them the power to pronounce the final verdict on the recipient.

Notable Quotables

- **Epistle; Exact quotation** — William Lyon Phelps, *Reading the Bible* (1919), pp. 8–9. The boy Phelps illustrates “the whole creation groaneth” as worldwide indigestion after forbidden apples; his mother calls it an original contribution to exegesis.
- **Gospel; Exact quotation** — J. S. Bach, *Siehe, ich will viel Fischer aussenden*, BWV 88 (1726), movement 4. Tenor narration yields to the bass *vox Christi* for “fear not” and the promise of catching people.
- **Epistle; Exact quotation** — Mary Baker Eddy, *Science and Health* (1906 ed.), chapter IX epigraph. Romans 8:22–23 opens “Creation,” then a few lines later introduces a strikingly different claim: Mind, not matter, is creator.

References

Primary and inherited sources

- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica (Vatican City: Typis Polyglottis Vaticanis, 1962), *Dominica Quarta post Pentecosten*, pp. 382–383, facsimile; all ten elements visually collated, with no seasonal substitution or reading unresolved under the identified baseline.
- Internet Archive, *Missale Romanum* (1962) item and public OCR locating aid; retrieval data, facsimile locations, and checksums: [propers/verified.md](#).
- Holy Scripture: Psalms 26, 78, 9, 12, and 17 in full; Romans 8:1–25; Luke 5:1–11; John 21:1–14; Philippians 2:12–13. Psalm numbering follows the Vulgate and missal.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 14 on Romans*, on 8:18–23, text; *Homily 8 on Philippians*, on 2:12–13, text.
- St. Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* V.7.1–2, mortal body vivified; V.2.2–3, Eucharist and resurrection.
- St. Cyril of Alexandria, *Commentary on Luke*, at 5:2–8, Payne Smith translation; St. Ambrose, *Exposition of Luke* IV.68–79, Latin text.
- St. Augustine, *City of God* XIX.13, tranquility of order; *Tractate 122 on John*, 7, two catches.
- St. Augustine, *Confessions* VIII.5 and 8–12, divided will; *Grace and Free Will* 31–33, conversion, willing, and cooperating grace.
- St. Augustine, *Expositions*: Psalm 26, 1–3, text; Psalm 78, 12–13, text; Psalm 9, 6 and 9–10, text; Psalm 12, 3–6, text; Psalm 17, 2–3, text. English page headings use modern psalm numbers 27, 79, 13, and 18 where applicable.

Cultural works and verification sources

- William Lyon Phelps, *Reading the Bible* (Macmillan, 1919), pp. 8–9, Cornell scan.
- J. S. Bach, *Siehe, ich will viel Fischer aussenden*, BWV 88 (1726), movement 4; German libretto and translation.
- Mary Baker Eddy, *Science and Health with Key to the Scriptures*, 1906 ed., chapter IX, edition transcription. All links accessed 2026-07-10.

Search Scope and Limitations

Compact source panel

Text. All ten propers were collated with the 1962 typical-edition facsimile, pp. 382–383. **Direct reception.** All five appointed psalms, Romans 8, and Luke 5. **Related illumination.** Bodily resurrection, John 21’s second catch, grace and resistant willing, and Eucharistic nourishment. **Material limits.** The public Latin/English survey is broad but does not exhaust manuscripts, untranslated works, subscription databases, or modern scholarship. **Full records.** [propers/verified.md](#); [research/scope.md](#).

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